



Putting Rayla on the map

A setup guide for Google Business Profile

Everything to have ready, every step in order, and the mistakes that get a new profile suspended before it has earned its first review.

Prepared for

Ednar Nankya

Founder & Creative Lead

September 2026

Why this is worth an hour of your time

Read this part once. The rest of the guide you can work through with the laptop open.

When somebody in Kampala searches *marketing agency near me*, *video production Kampala*, or simply *Rayla*, Google shows a map with three businesses on it before it shows a single website. A Google Business Profile is how Rayla gets into that list. It is free, it takes about an hour, and nothing else in local marketing returns as much for as little.

It also decides what people see when they search for Rayla by name. Right now that space is empty, or worse, filled in by Google from scraped data that nobody at Rayla controls. Once the profile is claimed and verified, you own it: the photos, the hours, the description, the phone number people tap.

What the profile actually gives you

- **A place in the map results** for searches Rayla currently cannot appear in at all.
- **A panel beside search results** with photos, hours, services, and a call button.
- **Reviews.** Google displays them itself, which is why they carry more weight with a stranger than testimonials on your own site.
- **Numbers.** How many people found you, what they searched to get there, how many called, how many asked for directions. That last one is quietly the most useful marketing data Rayla will get for free.
- **Control.** Anyone can suggest an edit to an unclaimed listing. Verified owners approve or reject those edits.

One thing to settle before you touch anything

Whoever is signed in to Google when the profile is created becomes its **Primary Owner**. That person can remove everybody else; nobody can remove them.

This is why you are the one doing the setup. Create it on an account that belongs to the business, and add anyone who helps with the marketing as a **Manager** afterwards. Managers can post, reply to reviews, and edit the listing. They cannot take it with them.

Before you begin

Gather all of this first. Stopping halfway to hunt for a document is how details end up wrong, and wrong details are hard to change later.

The account

- ☐ **A Google account that belongs to Rayla, not to a person.** Use *hello@rayladigitalagency.com* if it runs on Google Workspace; otherwise make a Gmail such as *rayla.digital.agency@gmail.com* and treat it as company property.
- ☐ **2-Step Verification switched on**, with a recovery phone and recovery email set, before you start. Losing access to this account means losing the profile.
- ☐ **The password stored somewhere a second person at Rayla can reach it** if your phone is lost or stolen.

The business details

- ☐ **The name exactly as it appears on your signage, invoices and registration:** Rayla Digital Agency. Nothing after it.
- ☐ **A decision:** do clients come to your office, or do you go to them? This changes what you fill in and cannot be casually flipped later.
- ☐ **The physical address**, and the exact spot on the map. If the street address is loose, press and hold on the doorway in Google Maps and copy the **Plus Code**.
- ☐ **A phone that answers** on the number you list: +256 764 065 441. Have it with you during setup.
- ☐ **The website address:** <https://rayladigitalagency.com>
- ☐ **Opening hours**, honestly. Including Saturday, and whether the office closes over lunch.
- ☐ **A description** of about 750 characters, drafted before you sit down.
- ☐ **A list of services**, with one line of description for each.

The pictures

- ☐ **A square logo**, at least 720 × 720 pixels.
- ☐ **A landscape cover photo**, at least 1080 pixels wide, that shows the team or the work rather than a graphic.
- ☐ **Eight to twelve real photographs:** the team working, a shoot in progress, edits on a screen, the office from outside. No stock imagery, no watermarks, nothing that is mostly text.

For verification

- ☐ **Your URSB certificate of incorporation or registration**, and a trading licence if you have one.
- ☐ **Something tying the business to the address:** a tenancy agreement, or a utility bill in the business name.
- ☐ **Visible signage or branding at the location.** If there is none, put something up before you record.
- ☐ **A charged phone, and forty-five uninterrupted minutes at the office** during daylight. Verification is filmed there, not from home.

The setup, in order

Do these in sequence. Steps 4 and 6 are the two that decide whether the profile is approved.

0

2 minutes

Check whether a profile already exists

Search *Rayla Digital Agency* on Google Maps before anything else. If something comes up showing *Claim this business* or *Own this business?*, claim that one. Do not create a second.

Watch out. Duplicate listings are the most common reason a new profile is suspended, and untangling two listings takes weeks of appeals.

1

3 minutes

Sign in as the business

Sign out of every personal Google account first, or open a separate browser window for this. Whichever account is active becomes the Primary Owner, and switching that afterwards is a formal transfer, not a settings change.

2

3 minutes

Create the profile

Go to **google.com/business** and choose *Manage now*, then add your business. Type the name exactly as you wrote it down. Google will suggest existing businesses as you type; pick one only if it is genuinely Rayla.

Watch out. Do not add words to the name to help with searching. "Rayla Digital Agency Kampala | Social Media & Branding" is a suspension, not a ranking. The name field is for the name.

3

10 minutes

Choose the categories

The **primary category** is the single most powerful field in the whole profile. It decides which searches Rayla can appear in at all. Choose the closest honest description of the main work, most likely *Marketing agency* or *Advertising agency*. You can only choose from Google's own list, so try a few words and see what it offers.

Then add up to nine more categories for the other things Rayla really does: internet marketing service, video production service, graphic designer, website designer. Add only what you would happily be hired for tomorrow. Categories you cannot deliver bring enquiries you have to turn down, and Google notices when people bounce straight back.

4

10 minutes

Address, or service area

Google asks whether you have a location customers can visit. There are two honest answers and they lead to different profiles.

If clients visit the office: enter the full address, then drag the map pin onto the actual doorway. Google's automatic pin regularly lands on the wrong side of the road or in the wrong plot, and it is what a client's navigation will follow.

If you go to clients, or you work somewhere you would rather not publish: answer no, and set service areas instead. Kampala, Wakiso, Entebbe, up to twenty areas. The address stays hidden and the profile still appears in local results.

Watch out. Never list a coworking desk, a virtual office, a mailbox service, or a PO box. Google removes these when it finds them, and it looks for them.

5

5 minutes

Phone and website

Give a number a person actually answers during the hours you are about to publish, and the website address including **https://**.

Then check that the name, address and phone number here are written *identically* to the website, the Facebook page, the Instagram bio, and any directory Rayla appears in. Same spelling, same formatting, same number. Google compares these to decide whether it believes you exist, and inconsistency is a slow, invisible drag on ranking.

6

20 minutes

Verification

Google will offer one or more of: a recorded video, a live video call, a phone call or text, an email, or a postcard. **Choose video if it is offered.** Postcards to Kampala addresses are slow and frequently never arrive.

For the recorded video you film **one continuous take with no cuts and no editing**, showing, in this order:

1. The outside: the street, the building, and your signage.
2. The walk in from the street to where you work, so the two connect.
3. Inside: desks, cameras, lights, computers. The tools the business runs on.
4. Proof you are the one running it: unlocking a door or a drawer, opening the URSB paperwork, signing in to the business email on screen.

Narrate as you go. Keep colleagues' faces out of it unless they have agreed. If it is rejected you can usually record again, so read the reason Google gives before you do.

Watch out. Verification takes anywhere from a few minutes to five working days. While you wait, do not create another profile and do not change the business name or address. Both restart the process.

7

25 minutes

Fill in everything else while you wait

A complete profile ranks better and gets more calls than a sparse one, and this part can be done before verification comes through. Add the opening hours, and set **special hours** for the public holidays you close on. Add the services with their short descriptions, the year Rayla opened, and a booking link pointing at the consultation form on the website.

Then the description. Lead with what Rayla does and where it does it, because that opening sentence is all most people read. Keep phone numbers and web addresses out of it; Google strips them and it reads as spam.

8

15 minutes

Photos

Upload the logo and the cover first, then the rest. Give the files descriptive names before uploading. Profiles that get new photos regularly are shown noticeably more often, so plan on adding two or three a month rather than emptying the whole archive today.

9

10 minutes

Messaging and questions

Turn on chat only if somebody will reply the same day, because Google publishes your average response time next to it.

Then go to the questions section and post your own, with answers: *Do you work with businesses outside Kampala? What does a monthly social media retainer include?* Anyone on the internet can answer a question on your profile. Fill that space before somebody else does.

10

5 minutes

Add the team

Open the profile's settings, then *People and access*, then add. Invite whoever handles the marketing as a **Manager**. They can post, reply to reviews, upload photos and edit the details. Only you, as Primary Owner, can add or remove people or transfer the business.

Watch out. Never give Primary Owner to a contractor, a freelancer or an agency, however much you trust them. Manager access does everything the work needs.

11

ongoing

Ask for reviews, carefully

The profile gives you a short review link. Send it to clients you have finished work with, one at a time, in a message that mentions what you did for them. Five genuine reviews in the first month is a good target.

Reply to every review, warm or difficult, within a few days. A calm reply to a bad review persuades more people than the review discourages.

Watch out. Do not offer discounts, airtime or anything else in exchange for a review. Do not post reviews from staff accounts or from a second phone. Google spots clusters of reviews that arrive together from related devices, and it removes them — sometimes taking the profile with them.

Where this goes wrong

Every one of these is common, and every one of them costs more to undo than to avoid.

Creating the profile on a personal Gmail

The profile belongs to a person, not the business. When that person changes phone, leaves, or forgets the password, Rayla loses the listing and has to fight Google to get it back.

Instead: create it on a business account with recovery details set, before step 1.

Putting keywords in the business name

The fastest route to suspension there is. It is also the most reported violation, because competitors report it.

Instead: the real name only. Keywords belong in categories, services and the description.

Leaving the map pin where Google dropped it

Clients follow the pin, not the address text. A pin on the wrong plot produces phone calls from people standing outside somebody else's gate.

Instead: drag it to the doorway yourself, then test it by asking for directions from somewhere across town.

Using a coworking space, virtual office or PO box as the address

Google treats these as fake locations and removes the profile, usually without warning.

Instead: use a real premises, or hide the address and run it as a service-area business.

Publishing a home address you did not want public

Once it is indexed it spreads to other directories, and pulling it back is slow.

Instead: decide at step 4, before you type it, and use service areas if there is any doubt.

Picking a vague primary category

The profile quietly never appears for the searches that matter, and there is no error message to tell you.

Instead: choose the most specific category that is genuinely true, then review it after a month against the search terms in the performance report.

Rewriting the name, address or category days after verification

Large edits immediately after approval trigger a fresh review, and sometimes a suspension.

Instead: get the details right before submitting. If something must change, wait a week or two and change one thing at a time.

Different phone numbers or spellings across the website and social accounts

Google cannot confirm the business is one business, so it trusts the profile less and ranks it lower.

Instead: write the name, address and phone number once, then copy that exact text everywhere.

Setting it up, then never touching it again

Profiles with no recent posts, photos or review replies slide down the results while active competitors climb past.

Instead: fifteen minutes a week, on the same day each week. See the next page.

Buying reviews, or asking staff and family to post them

They are detected and deleted, and repeat attempts can cost the profile permanently. It is the one mistake here that is not recoverable.

Instead: ask real clients directly, personally, and soon after the work lands well.

If the profile is suspended anyway

Do not create a replacement, and do not delete anything. Read the notice for the reason, fix that specific thing, and submit the reinstatement appeal form Google links from the notice. Appeals usually resolve within a couple of weeks. A second profile turns a fixable suspension into a permanent one.

The first thirty days

Setup is the easy half. This is the half that produces enquiries.

Week one

Verify. Fill in every field the profile offers, including the ones that feel minor. Upload ten photos. Add managers. Post your own questions and answer them.

Week two

Send the review link to five past clients, individually, each with a sentence about the work you did together. Reply to every review that arrives.

Week three

Publish the first post: a project, a new service, a hire, a behind-the-scenes shot from a shoot. Posts expire after about a week, which is the whole point of them being a habit.

Week four

Open the performance report. Look at calls, direction requests, website clicks, and especially the search terms people used to find Rayla. Those terms tell you which categories and services to add next.

After that

One post a week. Two or three photos a month. A reply to every review and question. Updated hours before every public holiday. Fifteen minutes, same day each week.

Three numbers worth watching

Direction requests tell you people intend to turn up in person. **Calls from the profile** tell you the listing is doing sales work the website is not. **The search terms report** tells you, in your clients' own words, what Rayla is being hired for — which is worth more than any of it.

Compare them month to month, not day to day.

Worksheet

Print this page and fill it in before you open the laptop. Every field here maps to a field in the setup.

Google account for the profile

Business-owned, 2-Step Verification on, recovery phone and email set

Business name, exactly as it will be published

No location, no services, no punctuation you would not put on a signboard

Primary category

The one that matters most

Additional categories

Up to nine, all genuinely true

Address, or the service areas you will list instead

Add the Plus Code from Google Maps if the street address is imprecise

Phone number

Answered during published hours

Website

Including https://

Opening hours

Monday to Saturday, plus any holidays you close

First sentence of the description

This is the part people read. What Rayla does, and where.

Services to list

One line of description each

Managers to invite

Google email addresses, Manager access only

First five clients to ask for a review

Recent, and happy

Keep a record

Fill this in once the profile is live, and keep it where a second person at Rayla can find it. Not the password — that belongs in a password manager, not on paper.

Google account the profile lives on

Date verified

Recovery email on that account

Recovery phone on that account

Primary Owner

Ednar Nankya — this should not change without a deliberate transfer

Managers, and the date each was added

Three things that will come up later

The office moves. Change the address on the profile in the same week, and update the website, Facebook and Instagram the same day. A profile whose address disagrees with the website loses ranking quietly.

Someone leaves the team. Remove their access from *People and access* the day they go. Managers keep working access until they are removed.

You cannot get into the account. Recovery goes through the Google account, not through the profile. If the recovery email and phone from step 1 are not set and current, there is no route back — which is the reason they are step 1.

Rayla Digital Agency hello@rayladigitalagency.com +256 764 065 441 rayladigitalagency.com